General

THAIMUN XIII Committees

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MUN Procedures

- Committee Session
    1) Roll Call
        - All countries called, delegate responds with “Present” or “Present and Voting”
    2) General Speaker’s List
        - Chosen delegates give opening speech
    3) Moderated Caucus
        - Speaking rules apply
    4) Unmoderated Caucus
        - Informal session, delegates can walk around and talk to other delegates
    5) Drafted Resolutions
        - Done with multiple delegates
    6) Voting
        - Delegates vote for best resolution

MUN Terminology

- Moderated Caucus
  - Short statements/comments from delegates on sub-issues
  - If someone wants to speak on the subject, they must raise their placard and wait for the chair to call on them
- Unmoderated Caucus
  - Free movement
  - Talk to other delegates
  - Form alliances
  - Brainstorm resolutions

- Floor
  - Opportunity to speak
- Motion
  - Suggest an action
    - Extend debate time
    - Vote on resolutions
- Second
  - Agree with another delegate's motion
- Objection
  - Disagree with another delegate's motion
- Abstain
  - If a delegate is unsure about their vote they can choose not to say yes or no definitively
    - Does not fully agree
    - Agrees enough not to vote against

MUN Points

- Question or suggestion made by a delegate to the chair
- Usually regarding their comfort
- Types of points :
  - Point of Order
    - Objection to a procedure
    - The chair has made a mistake
    - Parliamentary Procedures are not done correctly
    - Must be made
    - Must say point of order whilst raising their placard
    - May interrupt a speaker who has the floor

- Point of Inquiry
    - For clarification
- Point of Information
    - To add onto another speaker statement/resolution
    - To bring down the resolution
    - Must be formulated as a short question
    - May NOT interrupt speaker who has the floor
    - Must be directed to the chair, even though it is aimed at the speaker
    - Max 2 times
- Point of Personal Privilege
    - When a delegate feels uncomfortable
    - Room too hot / too cold
    - May interrupt speaker to request for change in atmosphere
- Point of Parliament Inquiry
    - Point of info directed at chair regarding the rules of procedure

Committee Overview

USCC Overview

- **Committee Summary :** The USCC is a standing committee (a permanent panel) responsible for drafting legislation, conducting oversight, and recommending policy to the full Senate. In this simulation, the committee represents the "power of the purse" and the regulatory authority of the federal government.
    1. Primary Functions
        - Legislative Drafting: The committee's main goal is to write and vote on Bills or Resolutions. If a bill passes here, it would theoretically move to the full Senate floor.
        - Oversight: The committee "investigates" how the Executive Branch (the President and agencies like the State Dept or DHS) is carrying out laws.
        - Funding (Appropriations): Especially for the topics of Military Aid and Tariffs, the committee decides how American tax dollars are spent and how revenue is generated.
    2. Jurisdiction in Reality vs. MUN
        - In the real U.S. Senate, jurisdiction is strictly split:
        - Commerce Committee: Handles tech, NASA, trade (tariffs), and transportation.
        - Judiciary Committee: Handles immigration and law enforcement.
        - Foreign Relations Committee: Handles military aid and treaties.

In THAIMUN, these are combined into the USCC to allow you to debate the most pressing issues of the year in one room. This means you must consider yourself a generalist legislator who needs to understand the economic, legal, and international implications of every topic.

- **Agenda :**
    - Topic 1 - The Question of Imposing Tariffs on Foreign States
    - Topic 2 - The Question of Regulating Legal Immigration
    - Topic 3 - The Question of Providing Military Aid to Foreign States
- **Committee Allocations**

  Republican Majority
    - John Thune (SD) – Leader
    - John Barrasso (WY) – Whip
    - Tom Cotton (AK) – Rep Chair
    - Ted Cruz (TX)
    - John Kennedy (LA)
    - Josh Hawley (MO)
    - Chuck Grassley (IA)
    - Tommy Tuberville (AL)
    - Rick Scott (FL)
    - Joni Ernst (IA)
    - Rand Paul (KY)
    - Lindsey Graham (SC)
    - Tim Scott (SC)

- Deb Fischer (NE)
- Bill Cassidy (LA)
- Susan Collins (ME)
- Lisa Murkowski (AK)
- Mitch McConnell (KY)

Democrat Minority

- Chuck Schumer (NY) – Leader
- Dick Durbin (IL) – Whip
- Amy Klobuchar (MN)
- Elizabeth Warren (MA)
- Bernie Sanders (VT)
- Elissa Slotkin (MI)
- Andy Kim (NJ)
- Jacky Rosen (NV)
- Mark Kelly (AZ)
- Ruben Gallego (AZ)
- Adam Schiff (CA)
- Chris Coons (DL)
- Mazie Hirono (HI)
- Tammy Duckworth (IL)
- John Fetterman (OH)
- Sheldon Whitehouse (RI)
- Angus King (ME)
- Angela Alsobrooks (MD)

Directives

DIRECTIVES

- Directives are **actions that delegates/blocs take** to affect the committee.
- There are **3 types of directives**:
  1. **Personal Directive** - Individual submission by a single delegate.
  2. **Joint Directive** - Group submission by more than 2 delegates.
  3. **Cabinet Directive** - Group submission by the entire cabinet (Dem/GOP)
- Directives can range from requesting an executive order from the President to accusing a Representive of having committed a crime and requesting a federal investigation which could lead to censure or expulsion.
- **All directives are sent to the backroom** for approval via Google Forms. If approved, it is sent back to the committee **through press releases or crises**.
- Write **only one action/agenda per directive**.
- Consider the **3Rs**:

  Request - What are you trying to do? Be as detailed as possible with 5W1H (Who, What, When, Where, Why, How)

  Resource - Does your character have enough resources or authority for the directive to be realistically carried out?

  Reason - Why are you doing this? Justify your actions.
- **Consider the possible consequences of your directive**. Even if the backroom does not approve the directive, the directive may be twisted into a crisis against you and your colleagues.

Personal Directives

- Deploy <u>all</u> of the Texan *state guard* to major border points
  - **Quantity:** 1,900 people
  - **Locations**: El Paso, Tornillo, Fort Hancock, Presidio, Del Rio, Eagle Pass, Laredo, Brownsville, McAllen, and Rio Grande City
  - **Date:** Immediately
  - **Purpose:** For strengthening the border between Mexico and Texas, preventing Cartel corruption.
- Provide **5%** of the Texan biennial budget to contribute to building the border wall
  - **Quantity:** 5% = 8 billion USD
  - **Provided to:** The Texas Facilities Commission (TFC)
  - **Date:** July 15th
  - **Purpose:**

Key Terms

Key Terms

- Key Terms (Topic 1)
- Key Terms (Topic 2)
- Key Terms (Topic 3)

Key Terms (Topic 1)

Key Terms (Topic 1)

Term	*Category*	*Definition*
Balance-of-Payments (BoP)	**Economic Terms**	● Comprehensive record of all economic transactions between one country and the rest of the world over a specific period ● Current account: mostly the "trade balance" (imports or exports) ● Capital/financial account: tracks flow of investments ● Cruz believes in localized purchasing and thus is not as concerned as other senators – instead values capital/financial accounts in the tracking of unfair trade practices and the "buying out" of America
Duties	**Economic Terms**	● Tax imposed by the U.S. Customs and Border Protection (CBP) on imported goods, often calculated based on a product's value, categorization, and origin

Excises	**Economic Terms**	● Indirect taxes imposed by federal, state, or local governments or specific goods, services, and activities
		  ○ Often "sin" products or luxury items
		● Usually levied on manufacturers or importers at the point of production or sale rather than for the consumer
		  ○ Increased excises often impact the costs of products for consumers

Imposts	**Economic Terms**	● A tax, duty, or levy imposed by an authority, most commonly referring to a tax placed on imported goods
Levy/Levies	**Economic Terms**	● Legal seizure of property or assets (such as bank accounts, wages, or vehicles) by government authority or creditors to satisfy an unpaid debt or tax obligation ● Used to collect delinquent taxes ● Before a levy the IRS typically sends a notice of intent to levy which allows 30 days to apply for a hearing
Subsidies	**Economic Terms**	● Financial assistance or a "handout" provided by a government to a local industry, business, or individual ● May take form in direct grants, low-interest loans, or tax breaks ● Goal to make local producers cheaper and more competitive against foreign imports ● Cruz sees this as economic warfare and opposes foreign-subsidies as well as the American subsidies provided to green energy and EV companies
Taxes	**Economic Terms**	● Mandatory financial charges imposed by federal, state, and local governments on income, property, and transactions to fund public infrastructure, education, and defense ● Governed mainly by the IRS – legally required for

		individuals and businesses
Article 1, Section 8 (US Constitution)	**Legislation & Authority**	• Grants congress exclusive power to “lay and collect taxes, duties, imposts, and excises” and to “regulate commerce with foreign nations”
Commerce Clause	**Legislation & Authority**	• Legal basis for federal trade regulation • Limits executive branch’s ability to act unilaterally (without senate approval)
IEEPA (International Emergency Economic Powers Act)	**Legislation & Authority**	• 1977 law allowing the president to regulate commerce during a “national emergency” • SCOTUS ruling limits use for broad, permanent tariffs
Section 122 (Trade Act of 1974)	**Legislation & Authority**	• Rarely used law allowing the President to impose temporary (150 day) tariffs to deal with “serious” US balance-of-payment deficits
Section 232 (Trade Expansion Act of 1962)	**Legislation & Authority**	• Allows for tariffs on imports that threaten “national security” • Commonly used for steel and aluminium
Section 301 (Trade Act of 1974)	**Legislation & Authority**	• Permits the US to take action against foreign nations that violate trade agreements or engage in unfair trade practices, such as IP theft
Ad Valorem Tariff	**Types of Tariffs**	• Calculated as a percentage of the value of the imported good (e.g., 10% of tax of a car’s value)
Counter Vailing Duties (CVD)	**Types of Tariffs**	• Extra tariffs imposed on imports to affect subsidies
Dumping/Anti-Dumping Duties	**Types of Tariffs**	• When a country exports goods at price lower than their home market or cost of production • “Anti-dumping” tariffs are used to neutralize the advantage
Reciprocal Tariff	**Types of Tariffs**	• Levying a tax on a foreign state equal to the tax they levy on US goods
Specific Tariff	**Types of Tariffs**	• Flat fee charged per unit of good – regardless of value (e.g., $5 per barrel of oil)
Tariff Rate Quota	**Types of Tariffs**	• Two-tiered tariff where a down rate applies to a specific quantity of imports and a much higher rate applies once the quota is exceeded
Rules of Origin	**Trade Procedures**	• Criteria used to determine where a product was actually made • Used to prevent countries (like China) from “laundering” goods through a third party (like Mexico or Vietnam) to avoid tariffs.
Protectionism	**Values**	• Policy shielding a nation’s domestic industries from foreign competition by taxing imports • Distorts markets
Trade Liberalization	**Values**	• Removal, reduction, or restrictions or barriers on the free exchange of goods between nations • End goal (free trade)

Key Terms (Topic 2)

Key Terms (Topic 2)

Term	*Category*	*Definition*
Public Charge Rule	**Conditions**	● Regulation allowing denial of green cards to individuals believed to be become primarily dependent on government support ● Cruz supports this as it ensures immigrants don't become a tax on the American people through ensuring economic-independence and sustainability
Inadmissability	**Conditions**	● Legal grounds (criminal record, health issues, or security risks) that prevent a person from receiving a visa or entering the country ● Cruz advocates for the "broadest" possible interpretation of this especially for criminality
Inadmissibility Health Issues	**Conditions**	● Significant communicable diseases: ○ Tuberculosis, active ○ Syphilis, infectious ○ Gonorrhea ○ Hansen's disease, infectious ○ Quarantinable communicable diseases → cholera, plague, small pox, yellow fever, viral hemorrhagic fevers (ebola, lassa, marburg), SARS ○ PHEICs ● Vaccine preventable diseases ○ Diphtheria ○ Haemophilus influenzae Type B ○ Hepatitis A ○ Hepatitis B ○ Influenza ○ Measles ○ Meningococcal disease ○ Mumps ○ Pertussis ○ Pneumococcal disease ○ Polio ○ Rotavirus ○ Rubella ○ Tetanus ○ Varicella ● Substance abuse disorders/drug addiction ● Mental health issues associated with harmful behaviours ○ Schizophrenia and psychotic disorders ○ Mood disorders (bipolar, MDD) ○ PTSD, panic disorders ○ Anti-social, borderline, paranoid personality disorder ○ Sexual paraphilic disorders ○ If the condition is a result of the environment that can be cured by the relocation to the US individuals may not be deemed inadmissible ○ Appeal (Form-I-601)

Visa Overstays	**Consequences & Risks**	● When an individual enters legally on a temporary visa but fails to leave once it expires ● Cruz notes that 40% of “illegal” immigration comes from overstays ● Cruz supports making the first overstay a misdemeanor and a second a felony
Aggravated Felony	**Consequences & Risks**	● Category of crimes that carry health immigration consequences including; mandatory deportation and a lifetime ban on re-entry ● Cruz wants to expand this to include repeated “low-level” crimes to “clean-up” the immigration pool
Visa Integrity Fee (3250)	**Fees**	● New surcharge implemented in 2026 for most non-immigrant applications to fund border security and fraud detection ● Cruz supports the idea that foreigners pay for the system that benefits them
$100,000 H1B Surcharge	**Fees**	● Controversial 2025/2026 fee for certain new H-1B petitions filed from outside the US ● Cruz supports fees but is cautious of the impact on Texan tech companies while promoting the use of local workers instead of foreign employees
The Laken Riley Act	**Legislation**	● Law requiring the mandatory detention of any undocumented immigrant charged with theft or burglary ● Cruz supports this as an “accountability” mechanism
Stop Illegal Aliens Drunk Driving Act	**Legislation**	● 2026 bill (supported by Cruz) that makes DUI/DWI an “aggravated felony” for immigration processes ● Cruz is protecting public safety through this “shield”
One Big Beautiful Bill Act (OBBBA)	**Legislation**	● 2025/2026 omnibus bill – funded border wall, reconstructed several visa categories ● Cruz sees this as a “blueprint” for a secure and functional system
Merit-Based System (Points Based)	**Systems**	● Immigration model where visas are awarded to those ranking high in education, high-demand skills, English proficiency, and age – not family ties ● Cruz’s “gold standard” – believes in recruiting the “best and brightest” to compete with China
Chain Migration (Family Based)	**Systems**	● Term used by critics to describe the process where one legal immigrant can sponsor a wide range of extended family members (parents, siblings, adult children) ● Cruz believes in limiting this to only spouses and minor children to prevent “infinite” backlog
Diversity Visa Lottery	**Systems**	● Program that grants 55,000 green cards annually to people from countries with low immigration rates to the US (chosen at random) ● Cruz sees this as “arbitrary” and “illogical” – should be merit based not random
Weighted Lottery (2026 Rule)	**Systems**	● New policy prioritizing H-1B visas with the highest salaries

		● Cruz strongly supports this
Adjustment of Status	**Systems**	● Process used to apply for lawful permanent residency (LPR) status (issuing a green car when the applicant is already physically present in the US. ● Cruz believes this must be strictly scrutinized to ensure physically present applicants aren't skipping the cue ahead of overseas applicants
Naturalization	**Systems**	● Legal actor process by which a non-citizen acquires US citizenship ● Cruz sees this as a "sacred privilege", not a right – emphasizes that the <u>oath of allegiance</u> must be meaningful
Expedited Removal	**Systems**	● Process that allows immigration officers to deport certain non-citizens quickly without a hearing before an immigration judge ● Cruz supports expanding this to clear the massive backlog in immigration court that "clogs the system" for legitimate applicants
Numerical Caps	**Systems**	● Statutory limits on how many immigrants can be admitted in specific categories each year ● Cruz opposes the raising of these caps unless paired with the elimination of lottery visas and chain migration
Rule of Law	**Systems**	● Principle that all people and institutions are accountable to laws that are fairly applied and enforced ● Any "amnesty" or "loophole" is an attack on the rule of law according to Cruz
Oath of Allegiance	**Systems**	● Formal, binding declaration of loyalty made by new citizens (immigrants), public officials, or military personnel to a country, its constitution, or a monarch ● Final, mandatory step in the naturalization process ○ Requires individuals to renounce prior foreign allegiances and pledge to defend their new nations laws.
H-1B Visa (Specialty Occupation)	**Type of Visa**	● Non-immigrant visa that allows US employers to temporarily employ foreign workers in "specialty" fields like tech or engineering ● Cruz supports this but advocates for a "wage-level" floor to ensure companies aren't just using foreign labour as a means to cut costs and replace American workers
National Interest Waiver (NIW)	**Type of Visa**	● Green card category for those whose work would significantly benefit the US – allows them to bypass the job offer requirements ● Cruz supports this for scientists and engineers especially in energy and aerospace

Key Terms (Topic 3)

Key Terms (Topic 3)

Term	*Category*	*Definition*
Peace Through Strength		• Foreign policy doctrine heavily associated with Ronald Reagan & Donald Trump • Proposes that maintaining overwhelming military, economic, and technological superiority deters aggression and ensures national peace • Focuses on preventing war by making potential adversaries fear the consequences of attacking.
Strategic Ambiguity		• Deliberate use of vague or imprecise communication by organizations, or governments to achieve specific goals, such as maintaining flexibility, managing diverse stakeholder expectations, or deterring opponents • Avoiding precise commitment – allows for adapting to complex, high-stakes environments while keeping options open.
End-Use Monitoring (EUM)		• Verification process – notably the DoDs "Golden Sentry" program • Ensures defense articles and services transferred to foreign nations are secured, used as agreed, and not transferred without authorization • Involves physical inspections, inventory checks, and accountability – reports to prevent diversion or misuse of sensitive technology • Covers foreign military sales (FMS) and direct commercial sales • Routine checks are standard • Enhances EUM (EEUM) – stricter, more frequent inventory checks for sensitive items such as night vision devices or missiles • Managed by defense security cooperation agency (OSCA) • Violations can result in suspension of future arms transfers
Foreign Military Financing (FMF)		• Enables eligible partner nations to purchase US defense artoc;es services, and training through either FMS or for a limited number of countries through the foreign military financing of direct commercial contracts (PMF/DCC) program • Source of financing may be provided to a foreign country on either a grant (non-repayable) or direct or guarantee loan basis.
Qualitative Military Edge (QME)		• Legal long-standing foreign policy commitment • Ensures Israel has superior weapons, technology, and tactics to detect any conventional threat or coalition. • Allows Israel to overcome numerical disadvantages – often requires US-backed advanced arms sales • Requires mandated assessments for regional arms deals since 2008

		● Used to maintain a strong rapport with Israel and to "maintain peace" within the middle east.

Lend-Lease Act		● Passed in March 1941
		● Authorized the US president to transfer, lend, or lease war materials to any nation deemed "vital" to the defense of the United States
		  ○ Including weapons, food, and oil
		● Allowed America to support allied forces – primarily Britain and later the Soviet Union
		  ○ Officially remaining neutral before entering World War II
		● Circumvents the need for cash-on-hand
		● Used to help allied nations fight against Axis powers without requiring immediate payment
		● Remained a cornerstone of allied supply chains until 1945 (end of WWII)

The Abraham Accords		● A series of joint normalization agreements brokered by the US in 2020 ● Establishes formal, diplomatic, economic, and security ties between Israel and several Arah nations (UAE, Bahrain, Sudan, Morocco) ● Represents shared Abrahamic roots – represents first major Arab - Israeli peace normalization since 1994.
NATO Article 5		● Cornerstone of the alliance ● Establishes that an armed attack against one or more of it's members in Europe or North America is considered an attack against all ● Obliges members to assist the attacked party, including through armed force ● Acts on the principle of collective defense ● Invoked once – post 9/11 ● Requires a unanimous decision to invoke
Interoperability		● The ability of military equipment or groups to operate in conjunction with each other
Lethal Aid		● Refers to the transfer of defense articles such as weapons, munitions, and ammunition from one state to another ● Typically to support partners military during a conflict ● Used in geopolitical situations like the Russia-Ukraine and the conflicts in the Middle East
Humanitarian Aid		● Short-term urgent assistance ● Includes: food, water, shelter, and medical care ● Designed to save lives and alleviate suffering for people affected by conflicts, natural disasters and other crises ● Guided by neutrality and impartiality principles ● Addresses immediate needs to maintain human dignity.
Proxy War		● Military conflict where major powers support third parties (e.g. smaller nations or non-state actors) ● Fighting on behalf of the smaller nation to avoid direct confrontation ● Provides weapons, training, funding, or intelligence to surrogate forces

		● Occurs during civil wars or in unstable regions where foreign powers fuel the conflict ● Reduces risk for possible nuclear engagement and high-level direct wars
Nuclear Non-Proliferation		● Aims to prevent the spread of nuclear weapons, promote peaceful nuclear energy use, and achieve disarmament ● Treaty of nuclear non-proliferation splits nations into nuclear weapon states (US, UK, France, China, Russia) and non-nuclear weapon states ○ Overseen by the IAEA (was extended indefinitely in 1955)
Sanctions		
Sanctions Relief		● The reduction, suspension, or lifting of economic and political restrictions imposed by a country, entity, or individual ● Typically used as a diplomatic tool – rewarding compliance with international agreement by restoring trade, financial transactions, or diplomatic relations ● Sanctions can be automatically reimposed if the receiving party breaches the agreement ● Includes the removing of entities from blockers lists, allowing them to conduct financial transactions and use trade embargo's
Trade Embargo's		
Asymmetric Warfare		● When a conflict between opposing forces includes significant disparities in military power ● The weaker side may employ unconventional tactics (guerilla warfare, terrorism, and cyber attacks) ● Focuses on eroding the will to fight rather than direct military superiority ● Weaker party aims to make the conflict as costly as possible – too costly in terms of money, lives, or political capital ● Line between combatants and civilians is blurred ● US army has a group dedicated to developing counter-tactics ○ Uses specialized, low cost equipment for detecting IEDs and navigating combat environments
Taiwan Policy Act of 2022 (S.4428)		● Major US legislative initiative to fundamentally restructure and strengthen relations with Taiwan proposes over $4.5 billion in security assistance ● Designated Taiwan as a "major non-NATO ally" ● Aims to enhance support for its international participation – to deter Chinese aggression ● Advocates for Taiwan's inclusion in the UN through committees such as WHO ● Establishes a sanctions framework against China if it exerts force against Taiwan
Oversight Mechanism		● Structure processes, institutions, or bodies – such as auditors, citizen review boards, or parliamentary

		committees ● Monitor, evaluate, and supervisor organizations to ensure accountability, comp;iance with laws, and ethical behavior ● Prevents corruption, improves performance, and protects against unfair treatment ● To detect and stop illegal, unethical, or inefficient behaviors
Sovereign Debt		● Money borrowed by a national government from domestic or foreign creditors to finance public spending. Infrastructure, and development when tax revenues are insufficient ● Internal = owes to residents | external = owes to foreign creditor/s ● Through government issue bonds, bills, and notes to investors to raise funds ● High debt can cause economic instability ● IMF aids nations when they struggle with repayment
National Security Strategy (NSS)		● Released in 2025 – emphasizes “America First” doctrine ● Highlights the need for economic stability and strength, border security, and technological dominance ● Prioritizes deterring China from Taiwan by providing Taiwan with more than enough military power to fight and even win against China ● Tough love approach with European nations ● “Realignment through peace” – prioritizes US interests and prosperity while demanding allies to take more responsibilities for regional defense ● Aims to maintain leadership in AI and other critical technologies
Rules of Engagement (RoE)		● Authorized directives – issued as “RoE cards” ● Defines when, where, and how military force is used ● Dictates self-defense actions, target identification, and civilian protection ● Limits force to what is “necessary” for the mission ● Balances political, legal, and operational needs – tailored to specific missions by commanders ● To prevent unnecessary suffering and safeguard human rights ● Requires distinction between combatants and civilians/civilian property ● Only competent military authorities issue these directives
Burden Sharing		● The equitable distribution of costs, risks, and responsibilities ● Includes: financial contributions, military defense, or refugee support ● Among groups or alliances to achieve common goals ● Commonly used in international relations, environmental policy and to describe the economic risks shared through crisis.

Committee Stances

Committee Stances

- Committee Stances (Topic 1)
- Committee Stances (Topic 2)
- Committee Stances (Topic 3)

Committee Stances (ALL Topics)

Committee Stances

Senator	Rep/Dem	Unique Stance
John Thune (SD) – Leader	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ Supports the GOP agenda for implementing tariffs on foreign states but is being pressured by citizens to include relief packages ● Immigration ○ Supports ICE and DHS and the building of the border wall. ○ Illegal immigration seen as a security threat ● Military Aid ○ “Iran must never have nuclear weapons” ○ Believes the FY2026 National Defense Authorization Act (NDAA) is critical to protecting our world ○ Focused on the golden dome missile defences
John Barrasso (WY) – Whip	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ Fair trade hawk ○ Concerned about uranium imports (and laundering) ○ Frustrated with mark-up in prices ● Immigration ○ Supports the Laken Riley Act ○ Key player in the passing of OBBBA ○ Loves the wall ● Military Aid ○ Defends Operation Epic Fury (Iranian strikes by Israel) ○ By destroying Iran’s strength, we are all safer
Tom Cotton (AK) – Rep Chair	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ Supports tariffs to oppose China ● Immigration ○ RAISE Act supporter ○ Deportation Acceleration Act supporter & author ● Military Aid ○ “Our offer can be: you meet our demands, or we bomb you” ○ He believes we must provide whatever is necessary to ensure these nations can survive as "outposts of freedom" against the "China-Iran-Russia axis".
Ted Cruz (TX)	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ For leverage ○ Must not impact civilians negatively ○ Investment in national economy – America first ● Immigration ○ No chain migration ○ Illegal immigrants quickly deported

		○ Fair processes that allow a structured order of applicants ● Military Aid ○ For supporting Taiwan & Israel ○ Believes the strikes are a means to an end ○ Believes US military aid can be instrumental in a developing nation
John Kennedy (LA)	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ Hates unauthorized bodies making decisions on such matters ● Immigration ○ Cosponsored Stop Illegal Aliens Drunk Driving Act ○ Frustrated by slow-walking bureaucracy ○ Supports OBBBA ● Military Aid ○ Peace through strength ○ Must strengthen nuclear power during these times
Josh Hawley (MO)	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ Wants to abolish WTO ○ End trade with China ○ Wants to turn tariff revenue into direct cash for the working class ● Immigration ○ Pushing the Empowering States to Deport Illegal Immigrants Act ● Military Aid ○ Support focus on China deterrence through Taiwan support ○ Arm Taiwan Act ($3 billion annually)
Chuck Grassley (IA)	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ Expiration unless passed within 60 days ○ Concerned about high input costs (fertilizer) on farmers in Iowa ● Immigration ○ BUILT IT Act ● Military Aid ○ Worried about the impact on product costs (grain and fuel) on citizens ○ Codified aid
Tommy Tuberville (AL)	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ Supports tariffs to prevent farmers from being robbed ● Immigration ○ Believes it has never been this bad and is a result of democratic presidencies ● Military Aid ○ Wants to redirect humanitarian aid (for Gaza) to supplying Israel with military lethal aid ● Supports speed over everything & supports Trump on everything
Rick Scott (FL)	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ CLEAR Act – kicks out Chinese entities from the US military supply chain ○ The mechanism to level the playing field ● Immigration

		○ Believes democrats are prioritizing illegal aliens ○ Introduced the UASI Act – revokes federal funding from states that do not comply with ICE or DHS ● Military Aid ○ Wants Taiwan as a “NATO Plus” partner ○ Frustrated by delays in arms delivery to Taiwan and Israel
Joni Ernst (IA)	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ Fair Trade supporter ○ Aims to use wasteful climate spending to reduce the deficits ● Immigration ○ Lead author of BUILD IT Act ○ Supports the Secretary of the DHS (Markwayne Mullin) ● Military Aid ○ Sees Israel’s strikes as a generational action for peace ○ Believes Taiwan deserves high-quality aid not just leftovers
Rand Paul (KY)	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ Believes in the power of the purse ● Immigration ○ For the defunding of DHS – unnecessary government spending ● Military Aid ○ Against the aid for Israel & Taiwan – slows things
Lindsey Graham (SC)	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ Proposes 500% tariff on any nation that trades with Russia ● Immigration ○ Wishes to impose criminal penalties for officials obstructing ICE ○ Sanctuary cities are a hub for lawlessness ○ Believes in expedited removal and accelerated deportation ● Military Aid ○ Wants to destroy the Iranian regime ○ Co-author (with Ted Cruz) of Safeguard Israel Act: wants to defund the UN based on anti-Israeli bias
Tim Scott (SC)	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ Believes tariffs should be targeted and purposeful ● Immigration ○ Condemns restrictions on ICE and dislikes sanctuary cities ● Military Aid ○ Supported the expansion of the Nuclear Power Training Facility and develop a Comprehensive Cyber Workforce Strategy ○ Supports Iron Dome and Iron Beam (Israel)
Deb Fischer (NE)	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ Supports the demolition of barriers for local farmers to avoid the need for foreign imports ● Immigration ○ Views funding as down payments for safety ○ Parole reform – reduce abuse

		● Military Aid ○ Integrated deterrence ○ Secured 25m from OBBBA for the Golden Dome missile shield
Bill Cassidy (LA)	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ Introduced the SAFE Act ○ Condemns the presence of "Non-Resident Importers" — overseas shell companies that import goods, ignore tariffs, and then vanish before they can be audited ○ Supporter of Last Sale Valuation Act ● Immigration ○ Pushing the Emerging Innovative Border Technologies Act ○ Wants to make innovation teams permanent ○ Wishes to use AI & drones to combat fentanyl trafficking ● Military Aid ○ Supports a 50b defense package for Israel to maintain peace through strength ○ Essential to protecting the American economy and life
Susan Collins (ME)	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ Frustrated by the tariffs on Canada – aims to use USMCA to exempt certain products from tariffs ● Immigration ○ Withholding DHS funding until they agree to $20 million for body cameras and $2 million for de-escalation training for ICE ● Military Aid ○ Voted for 41 billion in aid for Israel (unconditional) ○ Impatient with administration for delayed aid ○ Hired Deloitte and KPMG to audit Gaza humanitarian aid to ensure it doesn't go to Hamas
Lisa Murkowski (AK)	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ Causing a loss of trust between NATO allies ● Immigration ○ Supports the Democrats' push for de-escalation training and requiring judicial warrants for ICE home entries. ○ Stated that "roving patrols" and "fishing expeditions" are "not what we do in this country". ● Military Aid ○ Supports Israel but has expressed skepticism about humanitarian aid being diverted to Hamas.
Mitch McConnell (KY)	***Republican***	● Tariffs ○ Sees trade wars as empty merit ○ Wants to maintain senate power ● Immigration ○ Stated "I think we have to follow the law, and I clearly do think we need more judges". ● Military Aid ○ Led the charge to defeat the Kaine War Powers Resolution, arguing

		that the strikes on Iran are a "necessary attempt to end a half-century war" ○ Wants military readiness
Chuck Schumer (NY) – Leader	***Democrat***	● Tariffs ○ Argues republicans don't understand the downfalls of tariffs ○ Aims to block any extensions of global tariffs (alongside the rest of the democrats) ● Immigration ○ Refuses to extend DHS funding unless agents: ■ Stop wearing face masks, ■ Start wearing body cameras ■ Start follow the same judicial warrant rules as local police ○ Is happy for the DHS funding to come to an end ○ Anti-ICE ● Military Aid ○ Believes the president is not helping anything and is "bumbling headfirst into another war" ○ Believes in Israeli aid
Dick Durbin (IL) – Whip	***Democrat***	● Tariffs ○ Furious about the direct impacts on manufacturing in the US ● Immigration ○ Using victim stories to oppose ICE ● Military Aid ○ Calls the strikes on Iran "unilateral war" without "justification, authorization, or a clear objective" ○ Directly contributes to the forced usage of foreign products that benefits opposing nations
Amy Klobuchar (MN)	***Democrat***	● Tariffs ○ Fighting to protect the revenue produced by retaliatory tariffs ● Immigration ○ Is unclear in stance ○ Supports Afghan refugees: Afghan Adjustment Act ● Military Aid ○ Strikes in Iran were initiated without authorization and has highlighted the "unacceptable risks" to American troops ○ Pushing the Antitrust Accountability and Transparency Act (AATA)
Elizabeth Warren (MA)	***Democrat***	● Tariffs ○ Wants to use the upcoming USMCA review as a means to tighten labour standards but not giveaway money to the rich ● Immigration ○ ● Military Aid ○
Bernie Sanders (VT)	***Democrat***	● Tariffs ● Immigration

		• Military Aid
Elissa Slotkin (MI)	***Democrat***	• Tariffs • Immigration • Military Aid
Andy Kim (NJ)	***Democrat***	• Tariffs • Immigration • Military Aid
Jacky Rosen (NV)	***Democrat***	• Tariffs • Immigration • Military Aid
Mark Kelly (AZ)	***Democrat***	• Tariffs • Immigration • Military Aid
Ruben Gallego (AZ)	***Democrat***	• Tariffs • Immigration • Military Aid
Adam Schiff (CA)	***Democrat***	• Tariffs • Immigration • Military Aid
Chris Coons (DL)	***Democrat***	• Tariffs • Immigration • Military Aid
Mazie Hirono (HI)	***Democrat***	• Tariffs • Immigration • Military Aid
Tammy Duckworth (IL)	***Democrat***	• Tariffs • Immigration • Military Aid
John Fetterman (OH)	***Democrat***	• Tariffs • Immigration • Military Aid
Sheldon Whitehouse (RI)	***Democrat***	• Tariffs • Immigration • Military Aid
Angus King (ME)	***Democrat***	• Tariffs • Immigration • Military Aid

Angela Alsobrooks (MD)	***Democrat***	• Tariffs • Immigration • Military Aid

Senator

Ted Cruz (TX)

- Texan senator
- Republican
- Tariffs
    - Yes for leverage
        - Lowest tariffs – ideal
    - No permanent
        - “Taxes on the American people” if left in place
- Immigration
    - Legal = yes
    - Illegal = insult to all those who worked to legally immigrate
- Quotes
    - "The Constitution is not a suggestion box. It is the supreme law of the land, and it is not subject to the whims of whoever happens to occupy the Oval Office."
    - "If you’re looking for someone who will simply go along to get along with the Washington Cartel, I’m not your guy."
    - "Liberty is not a gift from the government; it is a gift from God. And the purpose of the Constitution is to place permanent chains on the government so it cannot take that liberty away."
        - **Source:** Presidential Launch Speech at Liberty University (March 2015).
        - **Link:** Full Transcript - Washington Post
    - "My father is my hero. He fled oppression in Cuba with nothing but $100 sewn into his underwear. He came here legally, and he worked his way up to the American Dream. To equate legal immigrants with those who break our laws is an insult to every person who did it the right way."
        - **Source:** Republican National Convention Keynote (2012) and RNC Speech (2016).
        - **Link:** Video - RNC 2016 via PBS NewsHour
    - "A nation that cannot secure its own borders is not a nation."
        - **Source:** Originally Ronald Reagan; adopted by Cruz in the 2024 Senate Border Security debate.
        - **Link:** Cruz Senate Floor Speech - May 2024
    - "There is nothing 'compassionate' about an open border that empowers cartels, fuels human trafficking, and floods our streets with fentanyl."
        - **Source:** Senate Judiciary Committee Hearing on Border Security (July 2023).
        - **Link:** Transcript - Senate Judiciary Committee
    - "The greatest engine of prosperity in the history of the world is the American free enterprise system."
        - **Source:** Ted Cruz’s memoir, *A Time for Truth: Reigniting the Promise of America* (2015) and frequent campaign speeches.

- "The government doesn't create jobs; small businesses and entrepreneurs create jobs. Government's job is to get the heck out of the way."
    - **Source:** 2016 GOP Primary Debate in Milwaukee, WI.
    - **Link:** Transcript - Time Magazine
- "We must be the 'Arsenal of Democracy,' but we cannot be the 'Arsenal' if we have sold our manufacturing soul to the Communist Party of China."
    - **Source:** Op-ed and floor speech regarding the "STRATEGIC Act" and decoupling from China (2024-2025 context).
    - **Link:** Cruz Press Release on PRC Counter-Measures
- "If you stand with Israel, you stand with America. There is no middle ground when it comes to the survival of our greatest ally in the Middle East."
    - **Source:** Christians United for Israel (CUFI) Summit (2014).
    - **Link:** Full Speech - CUFI via YouTube
- "Appeasement never works. You don't stop a bully by giving him your lunch money; you stop a bully by punching him in the nose." (Often used regarding Iran).
    - **Source:** Senate Floor Speech regarding the Iran Nuclear Deal (JCPOA) (September 2015).
    - **Link:** Congressional Record - Senate Archive (Page S6565)
- "Our enemies should fear us, and our friends should trust us. Under this administration, we have too often seen the reverse."
    - **Source:** Presidential Campaign Foreign Policy Address (2016).
    - **Link:** Transcript - Council on Foreign Relations

- "With all due respect to the Senator, his facts are as vacant as his policy proposals."
    - **Source:** These are "Cruz-ified" versions of famous political adages (originally Daniel Patrick Moynihan) that Cruz uses frequently in Senate Judiciary hearings against Senators Bernie Sanders and Dick Durbin.
    - **Link:** Senator Cruz Debates Bernie Sanders - Town Hall Transcript
- “And that the purpose of the Constitution, as Thomas Jefferson put it, is to serve as chains to bind the mischief of government.”
    - https://www.washingtonpost.com/politics/transcript-ted-cruzs-speech-at-liberty-university/2015/03/23/41c4011a-d168-11e4-a62f-ee745911a4ff_story.html
- Imagine America finally becoming energy self-sufficient as millions and millions of high-paying jobs are created.
    - https://www.washingtonpost.com/politics/transcript-ted-cruzs-speech-at-liberty-university/2015/03/23/41c4011a-d168-11e4-a62f-ee745911a4ff_story.html
- Imagine abolishing the IRS.
- And imagine a legal immigration system that welcomes and celebrates those who come to achieve the American dream.

- Instead of a president who boycotts Prime Minister Netanyahu, imagine a president who stands unapologetically with the nation of Israel.
- The power of the American people when we rise up and stand for liberty knows no bounds.

Current Policy

Current Policy

US CONSTITUTION

Article, Section, Clause	*Category*
Article 1, Section 8, Clause 1	**Tariffs/Spending**
Article 1, Section 8, Clause 3	**Tariffs/Spending**
Article 1, Section 9, Clause 5	**Tariffs/Spending**
Article 1, Section 9, Clause 6	**Tariffs/Spending**
Article 1, Section 10, Clause 2	**Tariffs/Spending**
Article 1, Section 8, Clause 3	**Immigration**
Article 1, Section 8, Clause 4	**Immigration**
Article 1, Section 9, Clause 1	**Immigration**
Article 2 & 3	**Immigration**
Article 4, Section 4	**Immigration**
14th Amendment, Section 1	**Immigration**
Article 1, Section 8, Clause 1	**Military Aid**
Article 1, Section 8, Clause 3	**Military Aid**
Article 1, Section 8, Clause 12	**Military Aid**
Article 2, Section 2, Clause 1	**Military Aid**
Article 2, Section 2, Clause 2	**Military Aid**

Article 1, Section 8, Clause 1

Text : "*The Congress shall have Power To lay and collect Taxes, Duties, Imposts and Excises, to pay the Debts and provide for the common Defence and general Welfare of the United States; but all Duties, Imposts and Excises shall be uniform throughout the United States*"

- Clause 1.1 = Taxing Power
    - Congress can lay taxes, duties, imposts, and excises. Other than taxes, they must be standard across all states

- Clause 1.2 = Spending Power
    - The Congress can use the funds collected for federal programs such as social security, medicaid, and federal education programs.
    - Spending power also regulates underlying laws regarding local land-use decisions, the treatment of state-ordered institutionalized persons, and the prohibition of discrimination on certain grounds

Article 1, Section 8, Clause 3

Text : "*[The Congress shall have Power . . .] To regulate Commerce with foreign Nations, and among the several States, and with the Indian Tribes*"

- Clause 3
    - Congress shall have

Article 1, Section 8, Clause 5

Text : "*[The Congress shall have Power . . .] To regulate Commerce with foreign Nations, and among the several States, and with the Indian Tribes*"

- Clause 3.1

Resources & Funding

- Natural energy resources
- Multi-layered funding system
- Biennial budget cycle – 321.7 billion for the most recent period
- Produces two fifths (⅖) of the US' oil
- Produces one quarter (¼) of the US' natural gas reserves
- 1st in the nation for wind-generated electricity
- Top producer of solar energy – surpassed nuclear energy in 2024
- State GDP grew to 2.77 trillion
- #1 job creator in America
- 2022 - Texas recieved 88.9 billion from federal transfers
    - 25.7 of the total Texan revenue
- 48% supports public welfare and medicaid (-4% of the average)
- 20% supports health and hospitals (+6% of the average)
- 11% supports education (-1% of the average)
- 5% supports infrastructure and utilities (+1% of the average)
- 15% supports all other funds (-3% of the average)
- Sales tax → largest revenue → 62 billion per budget cycle
- Severance taxes → on oil and gas → 4.9 billion generated over the last budget cycle
- Franchise tax → business margins tax → 3.9 billion
- Recently secured 1.4 billion in federal funds for rural healthcare initiatives → including telehealth and workforce development
- Revenue dropped by 4% in 2024 → more cautious spending

Manpower (Dec 2025)

- Trade, transport, and utilities → 2,818,400
- Professional and business services → 2,118,800
- Education and health services → 1,985,900
- Leisure and hospitality → 1,541,700
- Manufacturing → 969,500
- Financial activities → 939,300
- Construction → 876,600
- Other services → 498,100
- Information → 224,200
- Mining and logging → 221,200

Military

- Over 104,000 active-duty personnel
- National guard (texas) → 22,367 - 23,200 personnel
- State guard → 1,900 personnel
- Veteran population → 1.4 million+
- Produces 100% of F-35 lightning II fighters
    - Most advanced multi-role aircraft
- As of March 2026, military deployed to patrol ports, energy facilities, and the border to enhance cybersecurity and physical protection amid international conflict
- 7% of state GDP comes from the military

    - Supported over 677,000 jobs and added approx. 157.2 billion USD in total economic impact

US Resources & Funding

- Labour force:
    - Public schools → 6,984,374
    - Hospitals → 6,016,085
    - Fast food restaurants → 5,109,652
    - Commercial real estate → 4,209,234
    - Professional employer organizations → 3,889,413
    - Manufacturing → 12,690,000
- Military
    - 150,463,900 people

Opening Speech & Position Paper

Opening Speech - Topic 1 (Tariffs)

Honourable Presidents and Fellow Senators, tariffs are merely taxes on the American people if not handled properly and with temporary intent. I believe that the use of tariffs should be limited to reciprocal taxes and taxes for the leveraging of trade with partnering nations. I am deeply concerned about the implementation of permanent tariffs against valuable nations, as these fees will have a direct impact on Texan farmers, labourers and citizens. While I believe the United States should be self-sufficient there remain products and services that are not prominently provided in the states. I strongly encourage each senator to investigate the state-wide impact of the President's tariffs to ensure our nation's economy is protected to the highest degree while maintaining national security and preventing interdependence between the US and other nations. Furthermore, as a congress we must commit to our constitutional values of maintaining uniform duties, imposts, and excises across all states to ensure no population is disproportionately affected by the increase or decrease in market prices. This congress is responsible for all permanent decisions impacting the American people as stated in Article I of the constitution. I propose the development of a tariff transparency portal designed for states to allow the general public to access information regarding updates on tariffs, how it directly affects individuals, and the products and services that may be specifically impacted. Through the tariff expert, citizens can inform their senators of the necessary changes that can then be brought to the congress table for bipartisan discussion. I firmly declare the immediate need for intellectual discussion on the highly relevant topic of imposing tariffs on foreign nations. Thank you, this senator yields the floor back to the presidents.
(90s)

Honourable Presidents and Fellow Senators, tariffs are merely taxes on the American people if not handled properly. I believe that the use of tariffs should be limited to taxes for the leveraging of trade with partnering nations. I am deeply concerned about the implementation of permanent tariffs, as these fees will have a direct impact on Texan farmers and citizens. Thus, I strongly encourage each senator to investigate the state-wide impact of the President's tariffs to ensure our nation's economy is protected to the highest degree while maintaining national security and preventing interdependence between the US and other nations. I propose the development of a tariff transparency portal designed for states to allow the general public to access information regarding updates on tariffs, how it directly affects individuals, and the products and services that may specifically be impacted. Through the tariff expert, citizens can inform their senators of the necessary changes that can then be brought to the congress table for bipartisan discussion. Lastly, I affirm that no

tariff must impact civilian healthcare, military aid, or border security. I now declare the immediate need for intellectual discussion on the highly relevant topic of imposing tariffs on foreign nations. Thank you, this senator yields the floor back to the presidents.
(60s)

Opening Speech - Topic 2 (Immigration)

Honorable Presidents and Fellow Senators, The United States of America has become a major hub for opportunity and innovation however with that power comes great responsibility. If we are being intellectually honest, immigrants without promising skills that directly benefit us, will merely take a toll on the American people through the use of social security and other federal aid. I strongly urge you all to take action against the illegal aliens present in our states through increased citizenship checks and traffic stops. While each state has the right to govern their own inner politics, we must avoid violating the constitution through amnesty and exceptions. We are required to collaboratively protect our land from those who leach off of our hard earned resources and infrastructure. Moreover, I strongly oppose the raising of numerical caps on immigration unless partnered with the elimination of lottery visas and further restrictions on chain migration. As the son of an immigrant, I affirm the importance of legal means of gaining citizenship through green cards and other specialized circumstances. My father was an honest and patient man who after providing a strong application for citizenship was eventually granted that privilege, one that must not be taken lightly or given unjustly. I refuse to allow any individual to “cut the line” in immigration procedures. I affirm the deportation of criminal undocumented immigrants and encourage the continuation of detainment for those who have already crossed the border illegally during prior inefficient presidencies. I believe that in order to clean up the immigration pool we must broaden our definitions of inadmissibility and expand our list of criminal activities that result in permanent bans and expedited removal. Lastly, I support the building of the border wall and increased funding to border control and homeland security to protect our fellow Americans. Thank you, the senator yields the floor back to the presidents.

(90s)

Honorable Presidents and Fellow Senators, The United States of America has become a major hub for opportunity and innovation however with that power comes great responsibility. If we are being intellectually honest, immigrants without promising skills will merely take a toll on the American people and economy. I strongly urge you all to take action against the illegal aliens present in our states through increased citizenship checks and traffic stops. We must protect our land from those who leach off of our hard earned resources and infrastructure. Furthermore, I strongly oppose the raising of numerical caps on immigration unless partnered with the elimination of lottery visas and further restrictions on chain migration. As the son of an immigrant, I affirm the importance of legal immigration pathways through green cards. My father was an honest and patient man who after

providing a strong application for citizenship was eventually granted that privilege, one that must not be taken lightly or given unjustly. I refuse to allow any individual to "cut the line" in immigration procedures. Moreover, I believe that in order to clean up the immigration pool we must expand our list of criminal activities that result in permanent bans and expedited removal. Lastly, I support the building of the border wall and increased funding to border control and homeland security to protect our fellow Americans. Thank you, the senator yields the floor back to the presidents.

(60s)

Opening Speech - Topic 3 (Military Aid)

Honorable Presidents and Fellow Senators, as a vocal advocate for Israeli military aid and Taiwanese deterrence against China through financial and military assistance, I believe military aid is essential to keeping the world at peace. As Ronald Reagan once said "We maintain the peace through our strength; weakness only invites aggression" and this is the exact concept I aim to extend to our loyal friend Taiwan. I, as the senator of Texas, commit to providing aid where necessary to ensure our global society thrives and is never hindered by irrational nations actions that go against the best interests of the world. In response to China's continued misbehaviour I propose a new legislation titled "ChiNO" this would impact China across various sectors but most significantly I propose that any positive or friendly act towards China must be passed with a ¾ majority to ensure the support or positive acts provided are not a pathway to dependence or underhanded trade behaviours. Furthermore, to really emphasize mine and the President's support for Israel, I propose IsrAmerica – a mechanism to enhance connectivity between our countries through extended visas, exemptions from tariffs, and most importantly national aid in the case of a local crisis including but not limited to; disease outbreaks, natural disasters, and political conflicts. While I am extremely supportive of Israel's strikes against Iran of which we have majorly funded – I strongly believe the expansion of aid will only strengthen our relations and develop an interoperable system of military defences. Lastly, I must be clear that all acts regarding military aid are not subject to citizen debate or appeal and are made in the best interests of national security and well-being. Thank you, this senator yields the floor back to the presidents.
(90s)

Honorable Presidents and Fellow Senators, as Ronald Reagan once said "We maintain the peace through our strength; weakness only invites aggression" and this is the exact concept I aim to extend to our loyal friend Taiwan. I, as the senator of Texas, commit to providing

aid where necessary to ensure our global society thrives and is never hindered by irrational nations actions that go against the best interests of the world. In response to China's continued misbehaviour I propose a new legislation titled "ChiNO" that would impact China through a rule that requires any positive or friendly act towards China to be passed with a ¾ majority in the congress. We must ensure the support or positive acts provided are not a pathway to interdependence for China. Furthermore, to really emphasize mine and the President's support for Israel, I propose IsrAmerica – a mechanism to enhance connectivity between our countries through broad national aid in the case of a local crisis including but not limited to; disease outbreaks, natural disasters, and political conflicts. I strongly believe the expansion of aid will only strengthen our relations with Israel. Lastly, I must be clear that all acts regarding military aid are not subject to citizen appeal and are made in the best interests of national security and well-being. Thank you, this senator yields the floor back to the presidents.
(60s)

Position Paper

Ted Cruz (TX, Republican) - USCC | THAIMUN XIII

Resolution Ideas

Bill Ideas (Topic 1)

- The Trade Master
    - responsible for the regulation of economic impacts by tracking the GDP, per capita income, import and export revenue, and innovation profit
- Limit of 365 days/1 year for all tariffs
- Tariffs must not impact or cause risk to healthcare, military aid, or border protection.
- 3IP - Triad of International Policies
    - IsrAmerica
        - Exempts Israeli products from tariffs as long as Israel provides the same benefit
    - Taiwanese America
        - Exempts Taiwanese products from tariffs as long as Taiwan provides the same benefit
    - ChiNO
        - Poses tariffs against all Chinese products (reviewed annually) – 200%
- If 80% of demand for a product cannot be sourced locally, 50% tariffs are the maximum allowed tax on such products.
- If 60% of demand for a product cannot be sourced locally, 70% tariffs are the maximum allowed tax on such products
- If less than 30% of demand for a product is externally sourced, up to 150% tariffs may be imposed.
- High-demand skill start-up package
    - Job Assistance
    - Housing Assistance
    - Visa Assistance
    - Financial aid ($1000 usd)
- *Refunds do not help anyone in reality*
    - *Companies are benefited not consumers*
- Subsidization by the state (funded by state revenue) for businesses and services in lower income areas/neighbourhoods (companies apply for tariff subsidy support)
    - – low income = less than 40k annual household income

Bill Ideas (Topic 2)

- Limit *chain migration* to <u>spouses</u>, <u>minor</u> <u>children</u> and <u>siblings</u>. - Up to 4 members of family
- Digital portal for submission — digital hearings (can be done in meeting rooms at public libraries)
- Proof of economic stability (lower threshold)
- Proof of job security
- Proof of residence
- Proof of healthcare coverage

- Proof of no criminal record
- Included: mental health considerations, physical illness considerations, familial ties
- Pre-Admission Travel Evaluation
    - Must fund and complete one 2 week surveilled trip to America for the purpose of job hunting or shelter searching and must leave ON TIME (if they overstay, they are permanently banned and will be expeditiously removed from the borders.
- Nation Cap
    - 1000 individuals per nation per 6 months
- Nations of the South (NOTS)
    - Establishing a cross-border collective aimed to assist Latin Americans in migrating legally to America
        - Office on the border and in major cities such as:
- Border Strong
    - $45 billion allocated to strengthening border security through the building of the wall and the training and employment of border control and homeland security
- 3IP - Triad of International Policies
    - ChiNO
        - Forces limitations on Chinese immigration (100 per year – only of the brightest)
    - IsrAmerica
        - Biannually reviewed contract that allows Americans and Israelis to be provided with up to a 120 day tourist visa.
        - Allows up to 5,000 Israeli immigrants per year
    - Taiwanese America
        - Allows for up to 2,500 Taiwanese immigrants per year

Bill Ideas (Topic 3)

- Taiwan = NATO plus
- 3IP - Triad of International Policies – *Requires 1/3rd of congress & no objections (to ensure agreement)*
    - Isramerica
        - Permanent agreement of mutual aid provisions in the event of any national emergency (including those unrelated to conflicts)
        - Defund UN bodies targeting Israel
        -
    - Taiwanese America
        - 24/7 portal and hotline that allows Taiwanese-Americans or Taiwanese Citizens to express their desires regarding US military aid
    - ChiNO
        - Calls for international sanctions on all Chinese military assets within America and allied nations
        - Requires a ¾ majority to pass any friendly act towards China
        - Revoke China's speaking rights in international forums
        - Chinese companies blacklisted – considered criminal to use within the US
            - Can sell to American owner or give up all rights as a company in the US

- Max of 1 year of similar/same lethal aid → prevent resource depletion
- Max of 3 years of similar/same humanitarian aid → prevent resource depletion
- NATO raise 200billion together monitored by US delegate → for Ukrainian support
- Supportive states send 0.1% of their fiscal budget to support Iran
- Supportive states send 0.025% of their fiscal budget to support Ukraine

- Benefits are oil prices lowered, human rights protected, world wide war prevented.

Motions & POIs & POCs

Motions

POIs & POCs

Motions

Motions

- **Motion to extend speaking time to 90 seconds**
- **Motion for __ minutes unmoderated caucus**
- **Motion for __ minutes moderated caucus on the topic of __**
- **Motion for a consultation of the whole for __ minutes on the topic of __**
- **Motion to open debate on resolution __**
- **Motion to adjourn session**
- **Motion to close debate on resolution __**

- **Motion to set agenda to Topic 1: The question of imposing tariffs on foreign states**
- **Motion to extend GSL speaker time to 90 seconds**
- **Motion for an unmoderated caucus of 30 minutes** *to develop joint directives and collaborate on ideas*

Topics

- Reducing the impact of tariffs on the American people
- Using tariffs as political leverage
- Reducing tariffs on foreign nations
- Localized investment as a means to reduce market distortions

- Regulating chain migration
- Preventing illegal entry
- Strengthening border security
- Addressing the detainment of illegal individuals
- Preventing criminality by immigrants
- Assessing the feasibility of the Lottery Visa process
- Implementing a strict merit based system

- Addressing Israel's military systems and attacks
- Providing Taiwan with Peace through Strength via Military Aid
- Lethal and Humanitarian Aid
- Maintaining a strong military presence without direct intervention or interference

POIs & POCs

POIs

This delegate would like to ask through the chairs,

- How does the delegate plan on ___?
- How does the delegate aim to __?
- Why does the delegate believe __ is necessary?
- What funding does the delegate intend on receiving?
- How does the delegate believe this will have a positive impact?

POCs

This delegate would like to ask through the chairs,

- What does the delegate mean by __?
- Can the delegate elaborate on the impact of __?

- **POI - point of information**
    - **This delegate would like to ask through the chairs ___**
    - Follow up (wait for it to be granted, 1x only)
- **POC - point of clarification**
    - **This delegate would like to ask through the chairs ___**

Topics

Speeches

For Speeches

Against Speeches

Main Sub Speeches

Other Speeches

Topics :

- Reducing the impact of tariffs on the American people
- Using tariffs as political leverage
- Reducing tariffs on foreign nations
- Localized investment as a means to reduce market distortions

- Regulating chain migration
- Preventing illegal entry and Strengthening border security
- Addressing the detainment of illegal individuals
- Implementing a strict merit based system

- Addressing Israel’s military systems and attacks
- Providing Taiwan with Peace through Strength via Military Aid
- Lethal and Humanitarian Aid
- Maintaining a strong military presence without direct intervention or interference

For & Against

For Speeches

Against Speeches

Reducing the impact of tariffs on the American people (Fillibuster)

Honorable Presidents, Esteemed Senators. We are not pieces of the President's puzzle. We are the decision makers, which is why it is crucial that we maintain the “power of the purse” and listen to our fellow Americans who stand victim to the government's mistakes. I cannot stand here and continue to let irresponsible policy makers decide the economic leverage America has. We as the states of America must own up to our prior mistakes and address them now. I propose many limitations on tariffs particularly to ensure no tax is implemented for more than a year without reassessment. I stand by the 26 million Texans; the farmers, labourers, citizens, and families who face the direct impacts of irresponsible tariff implementations.

I intend to stand here speaking against the continuation of unthoughtful tariffs for as long as necessary to combat the taxes which weaken our national economy and do not serve as necessary leverage for trading between our beautiful nation and other manufacturers of the world. I propose an additional body called the “The Article I Trade Commission” or “Trade Masters” that works under the congress to provide data and tracking on; the GDP, per capita income, import and export revenue, and innovation profit – across each state and the nation. The Trade Master is expected to provide biennial reports at the end of each fiscal term informing our congress of necessary changes that must be made in order to protect our hard working American citizens. I must however be clear that tariffs against nations like China must be encouraged but nonetheless reviewed.

My wife – Heidi, and children – Caroline, and Catherine are the individuals who mean the most to me. However, due to the state of global tariffs, my loved ones are being deprived of the American life that was once a dream-like reality, the one that my father set out to achieve in 1957. I want to tell you all a story, about a young boy who wanted to change the world, but first the state, and country. This boy's name is Ted Cruz. When I was 17, I joined the constitutional corroborators – a group of young politicians wishing to speak about the constitution and free-market trade. I then went on to be valedictorian, and was a key debater for Princeton University before being a top student at Harvard Law. All of these things could not have been possible without my family, and thus I will do everything in my power to prevent any body or individual from ridding my loved ones of the opportunity to witness economic growth, freedom, and collaboration.

While I align with the president on several matters, I must maintain conservative on this topic to protect our national economy and security. I believe that our citizens deserve only the best and that means not reducing spending power and increasing demand for locally produced products and services. I also believe that friendshoring and partnerships that reduce tariffs are highly beneficial to our political standing in international relations. I strongly affirm the exemption of nations such as Israel and Taiwan from tariffs or at a minimum a reduced tariff of no larger than 30% on any product. By creating these gateways for friendly nations, we empower ourselves to spread technological innovations that we can use until having developed our own, such as the numerous powerful computer chips manufactured by Taiwan.

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Now, I firmly believe that the forced implications of Chinese tariffs are merely a stepping-stone and an unfortunate process that must be conducted to ensure American independence and the utmost level of security in a national context. I strongly urge the congress to implement yearly tariffs of 200% on all Chinese products to disengage with China and revert to our strongest economic form. Although we rank first in the world for economic revenue, we are at a high-risk of political conflicts due to our appeal in production, trade, and opportunity.

Especially in Texas, I strongly affirm the limitation of tariffs and demand that all tariffs meet the criteria of not impacting or causing risk to healthcare, military aid, or border protection. Furthermore, I cannot and will not let any individual or group dictate the direction of economic change as the constitution states equal power between congress members and occasionally the president on many issues including taxes. Our constitution is our bible, and I believe that all aspects must be upheld to the most accurate standard. I will not rest until this congress affirms a legislative action to require reassessment of economic impact annually to review tariffs and their benefits or drawbacks.

Next I'd like to ask you all a question. Regarding tariffs — to what extent are we as consumers responsible for paying the taxes imposed to keep our world at peace? In order to answer this question, we must understand the fact that our taxes on foreign countries are rarely reduced or paid for by the opposing nation and are a tactic to reduce investment in foreign nations. This tactic however is found to be ineffective when taxes are applied on unique products that cannot otherwise be sufficiently provided by the United States. I firmly believe that if a threshold of 80% of demand for a given product is not met by local sources, tariffs on these foreign products must not extend past 50% and should be highly discouraged by this congress. And, if 60% demand is not met, tariffs may extend to 70%, and up to 150% if less than 30% is externally sourced

products. These are anti-scarcity laws that directly protect citizens while investing in our national economy in order to one day provide all products domestically.

I am not willing to entertain the concept of zero tariffs but am highly concerned about the current taxing landscape as it overrides congressional responsibilities and is rarely thoroughly researched which is why, I propose the development of a “Financial First Responders” (FFR) program where the congress selects a state-wide representative who is able to provide assistance in data collection for the Trade Masters. These FFRs would also be responsible for delivering speeches on the local effects of tariffs and the solutions to citizens and opening a portal for formal citizen complaints regarding tariffs and the Trade Masters. FFRs would be up for re-election every 2 years and are paid for using congress funding.

Lastly, we must stop allowing the executive branch to delegate responsibilities to other unauthorized bodies and must maintain our power through elected officials. I affirm bipartisan collaboration where all discussions are given their deserved platform, provided educated officials are on the front lines. Our beautiful nation doesn’t have to be a tariff machine, small changes are crucial to prevent side effects that must be prioritized.

Main Sub & Other

Main Sub & Other Speeches

Reducing tariffs on foreign nations

Honorable Presidents, Esteemed Senators, I am simply not in favor of blanket tariffs. I cannot stress enough how the tariffs on foreign nations are actually taxes on our people and markets. We are benefiting in such small amounts and I believe there is a better way. By providing allies with preferential trade deals and exempting partnering nations from tariffs, we can achieve economic prosperity **and** national security. We must not burn bridges with friendly nations, as trade can be quintessential to encouraging political change, especially in regions of high tensions. I believe that reducing tariffs to an 80/60/30 rule will re-engage our economy and strengthen all weakened sectors of the economy. The 80/60/30 rule is as follows: if 80% or more of a product is being supplied outside the US, up to 50% tariffs are permitted, if 60-70% of products are produced outside the states, up to 70% tariffs are permitted, and if less than 30% of a product is imported then tariffs may extend to 150% of the product's value. I firmly believe this rule will prevent overwhelming taxes that are unfairly paid for by our hardworking citizens. I must however encourage the continuation of reciprocal tariffs on unfriendly nations to force local investment through the raising of prices on foreign imports. I maintain my commitment to the protection of our nation through economic strength and growth. I can no longer accept individuals overruling decisions that were not meant for their choosing, I firmly believe that the development of a congressional sub-committee of elected state representatives to track financial impacts and changes over the course of the year. The senator yields the floor back to the presidents.

Regulating Chain Migration

Honorable Presidents, Esteemed Senators, this country is not a refugee hub and we must not treat it as one. Over the past 50 years we have housed over 3.7 million refugees and we cannot afford to continue allowing our American citizens to be left behind and disregarded. I

Addressing the detainment of illegal individuals

Honorable Presidents, Esteemed Senators,

Implementing a strict merit based system & addressing inadmissibility

Honorable Presidents, Esteemed Senators,

Addressing Israel's military systems and attacks

Honorable Presidents, Esteemed Senators,

Providing Taiwan with Peace through Strength via Military Aid

Honorable Presidents, Esteemed Senators,

Lethal and Humanitarian Aid

Honorable Presidents, Esteemed Senators,

Taking down the Iranian Regime

Honorable Presidents, Esteemed Senators, we must not forget our role in the Ukraine war but we must prioritize our actions in Iran to destroy the Iranian regime who are continuously violating the human rights of their civilians. We value democracy which is why we plan to reallocate power to elected officials that maintain the best interests of the civilians in mind. We must not however, get directly involved as that will risk our precious American lives and is not considerate of our increasingly depleted resources

Notes

Running Notes

- Countries trading with Iran – tariffs by USA
    - 25% for any goods
    - 50% sale drop – AK
    - 75% retaliation by China

Sources

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https://usafacts.org/answers/how-much-money-does-the-federal-government-provide-state-and-local-governments/state/texas/